

Necklaces
c. 1550–1069 BCE

Egyptian craftsmen had access to many semiprecious stones and precious metals. Necklaces were worn in daily life and also buried with the dead.



gold band
purple amethyst

Ear studs and earring

c. 1550–1069 BCE

Once the basic shapes for these studs and earring were made, strands of glass in a contrasting color were wound around them. The studs required large perforations in the wearer's lobes.



Wooden comb

c. 300 BCE

This double-sided comb has a row of longer and shorter teeth. Many Egyptians had short hair and wore wigs. Combs were used to keep both natural hair and wigs tidy.

backing for mirror

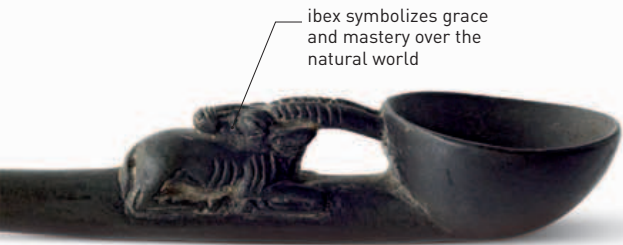


handle and backing made of ebony

Cosmetic spoon

c. 1360 BCE

This spoon for cosmetic paste was carved from schist in the shape of an ibex, with its head bent over its back, so that its straight horns touch the bowl.



ibex symbolizes grace and mastery over the natural world



Amulet

912–343 BCE

The wedjat eye symbolizes the eye of the god Horus. This charm was placed on mummies to protect the dead person's spirit in the afterlife. It also symbolized regeneration.

Mirror handle

c. 1360 BCE

This hardwood mirror setting originally held a polished bronze mirror disk. The handle is carved in the shape of a papyrus column topped with the god Bes—a popular deity.



disk representing sun

inlay held within cells of gold

Scarab pectoral

c. 1361–52 BCE

This magnificent chest ornament represents the scarab god Khepri rolling the red sun-disk. It was found in the tomb of King Tutankhamun.



Male figure amulet

c. 2200 BCE

This golden charm shows a kneeling male god clasp. He is probably the god Heh, who symbolized eternity. The palm ribs are notched, representing years.



Frog amulets

c. 1360 BCE

Frogs were a symbol of life and fertility. Women wore frog amulets for luck. These charms are made of blue faience (pottery) with details picked out in gold.



charm may have been part of a necklace

Winged scarab

644–322 BCE

Scarabs were common lucky charms. The scarab beetle was a symbol for rebirth and was worn as jewelry in ancient Egypt.